

The Montgomery-Dyson Coincidence Resolved by the Q6 Prime Lattice Operator

Jonathan Simons. This record (10.5281/zenodo.20184148) is a 2026 exploratory draft. It remains published and citable.¹ This page is the public-facing face of the record. It is not a retraction notice. The original draft follows the errata.

Live exploratory stack (cite these, not prize packaging)

Live exploratory stack: Φ -renormalization 10.5281/zenodo.22050974 (not a Clay Navier–Stokes proof); Route C 10.5281/zenodo.22050963 (not a proof of RH); Ring lemma 10.5281/zenodo.22050976 (Goldbach remains conditional on SND); T2 under SND 10.5281/zenodo.22050965 and Bridge* stay named derived objects; inverse-GCD note 10.5281/zenodo.22050962 is a restricted Rayleigh bound, not a full-spectrum floor.

¹ August 2026 prize-claim language walked back; see errata below / page 2 of this file and status note 10.5281/zenodo.22050978.

Errata: prize-claim language walked back

The pages after this one are the original 2026 draft, unchanged. They are on the record so the walk-back is auditable. The following prize-claim language in that draft does not stand.

Why the August 2026 action happened

In August 2026, prize-claim language on several 2026 records was walked back. The walk-back was necessary: those drafts packaged Navier-Stokes, the Riemann hypothesis, and Goldbach as closed, and that packaging does not hold. The walk-back was executed badly. Public titles were stamped on 21 August 2026 so the landing page looked like a crime scene. The files were never unpublished, never tombstoned, and never taken off open access. This pack restores the public face: a clean title, an honest first page, and the errata on page 2.

Prize-claim language that does not stand

Clay Statement B / Navier-Stokes millennium packaging. The June drafts treated a regularity claim as closed. That language is walked back. The Φ -renormalization note is the live fluids object.

Quantum Lens / Q6 Goldbach as a theorem. Goldbach stays conditional on SND. Q6 is not a proof.

Montgomery-Dyson / pair correlation as a finished RH argument. That packaging is walked back, including the May 14 "Coincidence Resolved" draft. Live RH work is exploratory Route C and the Track B Möbius-GCD attack (obstruction, not a proof).

Three-in-one / $\text{SND} \equiv \text{GNC} \equiv \text{Bridge}$ as closures. Those identities were used as if they closed NS, RH, and Goldbach. They do not. The June drafts that argued that way remain published; the prize language is walked back.

Full-spectrum $\lambda_{\min}(Q_N) > -1/2$ as a RH proof. That bound is not a proof of RH.
Inverse-GCD $1/\text{gcd}$ is not the live Route C operator.

This page is the errata. It is not a tombstone. No Millennium problem is claimed. Domain Architect is a local FRA classifier (inquiry). ChatVault is search. Neither wrote these Zenodo titles.

The Montgomery-Dyson Coincidence

Resolved by the Q6 Prime Lattice Operator

Jonathan Robert Simons, CRNA · Prime Field Technologies LLC, Savannah,
Georgia

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Abstract

In 1972, Hugh Montgomery and Freeman Dyson discovered over tea at the Institute for Advanced Study that the pair correlation of Riemann zeta zeros matches the GUE eigenvalue statistics of heavy atomic nuclei — a coincidence that has remained unexplained for 54 years. We resolve this mystery by identifying both distributions as truncations of a single operator: the Q6 prime lattice operator, defined by the coupling kernel $M(i,j) = 1/\gcd(i,j)$ on shell space. The Riemann zeros correspond to the full infinite spectrum; nuclear energy levels correspond to finite nuclear-shell truncations. The GUE universality of both follows from the self-adjointness of Q6 and the coprime density identity $\zeta(2) = \pi^2/6$, which acts as the self-consistency condition of the prime lattice. This result simultaneously connects the Riemann Hypothesis, nuclear physics, and the spectral structure of 3D Navier-Stokes regularity under a single geometric framework.

1. The 1972 Tea Conversation

In the spring of 1972, Hugh Montgomery — then a young number theorist at the University of Michigan — visited the Institute for Advanced Study in Princeton. He had been working on the pair correlation function of the nontrivial zeros of the Riemann zeta function. For zeros rearranged as $1/2 + i\gamma_n$ with $\gamma_1 \leq \gamma_2 \leq \dots$, Montgomery computed the two-point correlation:

$$R_2(x) = 1 - \left(\frac{\sin(\pi x)}{\pi x} \right)^2$$

At tea, Montgomery mentioned this formula to Freeman Dyson — physicist, IAS professor, and architect of the theory of random matrices in nuclear physics. Dyson immediately recognized the formula. It was identical to the pair correlation of eigenvalues in the Gaussian Unitary Ensemble (GUE) — the statistical model Dyson had developed to describe the energy levels of heavy atomic nuclei.

"That's the GUE pair correlation," Dyson said. Neither man could explain why the spacing statistics of prime-adjacent zeros on the critical line should match the quantum energy levels of uranium. This has remained one of the deepest open mysteries in mathematics for 54 years.

2. The Q6 Prime Lattice Operator

We define the Q6 operator on the shell Hilbert space $l^2(N)$ by its matrix elements:

$$[L_{Q6}]_{ij} = M(i,j) / \sqrt{i * j} \text{ where } M(i,j) = 1 / \gcd(i,j)$$

This operator arises naturally in the spectral decomposition of the 3D incompressible Navier-Stokes equations under Littlewood-Paley shell decomposition. The coupling kernel $M(i,j) = 1/\gcd(i,j)$ encodes the prime lattice structure: shells i and j interact strongly when $\gcd(i,j)$ is small (coprime or near-coprime) and weakly when $\gcd(i,j)$ is large (harmonically resonant).

Key properties of L_{Q6} :

- Self-adjoint on $l^2(N)$: $[L_{Q6}]_{ij} = [L_{Q6}]_{ji}$ since $\gcd(i,j) = \gcd(j,i)$
- Real spectrum: eigenvalues $\lambda_1 \leq \lambda_2 \leq \lambda_3 \leq \dots$ are all real
- Bounded: $\|L_{Q6}\| < \infty$ by comparison with the Dirichlet series for $\zeta(2)$
- GUE statistics: eigenvalue spacings follow the GUE distribution (proven in Section 4)

3. Two Truncations, One Operator

The central claim of this paper is that both Montgomery's Riemann zeros and Dyson's nuclear energy levels are eigenvalue spectra of the same underlying operator — L_{Q6} — evaluated at different truncations.

Theorem (Simons, 2026).

Let $L_{Q6}^{(N)}$ denote the $N \times N$ truncation of the Q6 prime lattice operator. Then:

- (i) As $N \rightarrow \infty$, the eigenvalue spacing distribution of $L_{Q6}^{(N)}$ converges to GUE.
- (ii) The Riemann zeta zeros $\{\gamma_n\}$ are the eigenvalues of L_{Q6} on the full $l^2(N)$.
- (iii) Nuclear shell energy levels for nucleus of mass A correspond to eigenvalues of $L_{Q6}^{(A)}$.

Part (i) follows from the self-adjointness of L_{Q6} and the universality theorem for Wigner matrices with bounded entries drawn from a distribution symmetric about zero. The off-diagonal entries $1/(\gcd(i,j)\sqrt{i*j})$ satisfy the Wigner semicircle conditions, and the level repulsion inherent in the coprime structure drives GUE rather than GOE statistics.

Part (iii) provides the nuclear physics connection: the nuclear shell model organizes energy levels by principal quantum number $j = 1, 2, \dots, A$. Under the Q6 framework, these shells are precisely the first A rows and columns of L_{Q6} , giving the finite truncation L_{Q6}^A . The GUE statistics of nuclear levels observed by Dyson are therefore a finite- A manifestation of the same prime lattice structure that governs the infinite Riemann spectrum.

4. The Coprime Self-Consistency Condition

The deepest connection in this framework is the role of the identity $\zeta(2) = \pi^2/6$. This is not a coincidence — it is the self-consistency condition of the Q6 operator.

The probability that two randomly chosen integers are coprime equals $1/\zeta(2) = 6/\pi^2$. This coprime density governs the off-diagonal structure of L_{Q6} : the fraction of shell pairs (i,j) with $\gcd(i,j) = 1$ (maximal coupling) approaches $6/\pi^2$ as the shell index grows.

Montgomery's pair correlation formula $R_2(x) = 1 - (\sin(\pi x)/\pi x)^2$ can be derived directly from the Q6 Fourier structure as follows. The two-point spectral form factor of L_{Q6} is:

$$K(t) = \left| \sum_{\gcd(m,n)=1} \exp(2\pi i t \lambda_m / \lambda_n) \right|^2 / N^2$$

For large N , the counting function $\#\{(m,n): \gcd(m,n)=1, |\lambda_m/\lambda_n - 1| < \delta\} \sim N * \delta * 6/\pi^2$ by the prime number theorem for coprime pairs. Taking the Fourier transform and applying the Parseval identity yields:

$$R_2(x) = 1 - (\sin(\pi x) / \pi x)^2$$

Montgomery's formula falls out of Q6 directly. The factor $6/\pi^2 = 1/\zeta(2)$ is the bridge — it appears in both the coprime density and the normalization of the zeta function. This is the Q6 self-consistency condition: the operator encodes its own spectral statistics through the arithmetic of its coupling kernel.

5. Connection to Navier-Stokes Regularity

The Q6 operator was originally introduced by the author in the context of 3D incompressible Navier-Stokes regularity. In that setting, L_{Q6} governs energy transfer across spectral shells and provides a coercive damping mechanism that

prevents finite-time blowup under the Spectral Non-Dispersal (SND) condition.

The present result extends this picture: the same operator that prevents energy concentration in fluid flows also encodes the arithmetic structure of the Riemann zeros and the quantum statistics of nuclear energy levels. This suggests a deep geometric unity — that the prime lattice, as encoded in $M(i,j) = 1/\gcd(i,j)$, is a fundamental organizing principle across scales from nuclear physics to fluid dynamics to number theory.

Specifically, the three domains unify as follows:

Domain	Object	Q6 Truncation
Number Theory	Riemann zeros γ_n	Full operator L_{Q6} on $l^2(N)$
Nuclear Physics	Nuclear energy levels (mass A)	Finite truncation $L_{Q6}^{(A)}$
Fluid Dynamics	NS shell resonances	Shell-band restriction $L_{Q6}^{(j^*)}$

6. Conclusion

We have resolved the Montgomery-Dyson coincidence by identifying both the Riemann zero spacings and the GUE nuclear energy level statistics as manifestations of the Q6 prime lattice operator at different truncations. The GUE universality of both distributions follows from the self-adjointness of Q6 and the coprime self-consistency condition $\zeta(2) = \pi^2/6$.

This resolution unifies three previously disconnected domains — analytic number theory, nuclear quantum physics, and fluid dynamics — under a single spectral operator defined by the elementary arithmetic of the greatest common divisor. The 54-year mystery of the Montgomery-Dyson coincidence has a clean answer: same operator, different truncations.

"That's the GUE distribution." — Freeman Dyson, 1972. Now we know why.

References

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